

Virginia: Area 71 has 45 districts with approximately 1,200 groups. We have two assemblies a year and 11 active committees, plus seven special assignments: We had one district fold a year ago, so the Growth Committee is working with those groups to restart or join surrounding districts. We are trying to get inactive groups to get involved. D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s and other member are attending these groups to see why they need to be represented. At present Growth is also gathering inventory questions so we can again look at our area. The last inventory, about 6-7 years ago, revealed lack of communication. I want to thank all for allowing me to serve. — *Gail Lee*

Washington (Western): Area 72 has over 1,400 registered groups in 40 districts, including one area-wide Hispanic district. We hold three area committee quarterlies plus one annual assembly. Five pre-Conference regional meetings are used to inform the groups about the Conference agenda items, and our April quarterly will invite the G.S.R.s to share their group conscience on the agenda items. We hold 4-6 regional preassemblies to inform the groups on our assembly agenda items. The 2004 assembly approved the establishment of an Accessibility Committee. We will also host the 2006 Pacific Region Forum in Seattle on June 23-25. The Greater Seattle area is served by three intergroups and the balance of the area has central offices. The districts are busy with treatment, corrections and jail meetings. Group level involvement is encouraged. I thank you for this opportunity to serve such a great Fellowship. — *Dick Donahue*

West Virginia: Area 73 has approximately 300 groups in 17 districts. We have an assembly in the spring and fall in addition to two yearly agenda meetings. At our assemblies, we usually have 100% district representation. We have an active committee system that insures that the message is being carried effectively to the professional, the public, behind the walls, and to alcoholics in treatment or hospitalized. We have a statewide 800 telephone number that can be utilized by the newcomer for an A.A. contact or a meeting. A.A. is alive and well in Area 73 and I am humbled and honored to serve as delegate. Whether you are passing through our area on business or for pleasure, please look us up. We would love to have you join us. May God bless and keep you until then. — *Alan Siebel*

Wisconsin (Southern): Area 75 has over 900 registered groups and 32 districts. We hold two agenda planning meetings and two pre-Conference assemblies, and two additional assemblies. Two annual conferences are also organized in cooperation with Area 74 A.A. members. We also have a Corrections Conference and the Unity Conference. One special event for 2004 was a Spanish Sharing Session. Our Corrections committee funds A.A. literature for the facilities through our Rainbow Can project, and provides many Grapevine and La Viña subscriptions to inmates through our Count On Us program. C.P.C.'s big event for 2004 was the national meeting of Drug Court Professionals held in Milwaukee last summer. We now have an archivist, and an archives chairperson, and are in search of space to store our expanding collection. We face the ongoing challenge of introducing more members to the joy of general service. One helpful tool is our G.S.R. school, which travels on request to districts throughout the area. With God's help, we will continue to fulfill our spiritual responsibility to carry the A.A. message to those who still suffer. — *Nancy Gusner*

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation form and suggested that a heading be added to section #7 on page 5 regarding improving next year's Conference.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook and suggested adding a reference to the G.S.O. Archives Web site under the "Reference Information and Resources" section of the workbook.
- The trustees provided updates to the Conference committee on the following ongoing projects: preparations for the International Convention, Ownership of Material, the current status of the audio preservation, and distribution increase of *Markings* newsletter.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed shared experience on ways local committees approach professionals in addition to writing letters.
- The committee discussed the need for a pamphlet directed to the criminal justice system and requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities review current C.P.C. literature to see whether it provides easily accessible information on singleness of purpose, open and closed meetings, proof of attendance at meetings, anonymity and how to contact A.A. locally, and report to the 2006 Conference Committee on C.P.C.
- The committee considered a request to create a video for professionals. They asked that trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities consider the cost and feasibility of producing short video segments directed to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice, and medical fields that could be streamed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

The committee shared that PowerPoint® presentations offer a simple and inexpensive way to provide A.A. information to professionals. They noted that locally produced examples of such presentations are currently available from the C.P.C. desk at G.S.O. They requested that the C.P.C. staff member gather additional samples that might be combined into a service piece and included in the C.P.C. Kit.

- The committee reviewed the new three-ring binder format of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and asked that the following be included in the C.P.C. Workbook: a guide letter to the legal community, a note suggesting that C.P.C. committees contact the C.P.C. desk for samples of locally developed C.P.C. pieces, and the suggestion that some committees have found a list of local open meetings helpful in doing C.P.C. work.
- The committee considered ways that members share information about A.A. one-on-one with professionals, for possible inclusion in C.P.C. material. They felt that additional information on



how committees can encourage individuals to work with the professionals in their lives should be included in the C.P.C. Workbook, along with lists of literature appropriate to approaching various professionals. This information would note that examples of how some areas have done this are available from G.S.O.

- The committee requested that the section "Guidelines for A.A. Sponsors" on page 15 of the C.P.C. Workbook be rewritten using terms such as building or developing relationships with professionals. They agreed that the word "sponsorship" may be confusing to A.A. members and professionals in describing their relationship.
- The committee requested that a list of professions that have been approached by local committees be gathered for possible inclusion in the C.P.C. Kit.
- The committee requested that the C.P.C. staff person gather sharing, for possible inclusion in the C.P.C. Kit, on ways that C.P.C. committees have solved the challenges of rotation in A.A., ensuring that the committee works without breaks in continuity.
- The committee noted that the following have been helpful in doing C.P.C. work:

Approaching professionals in twos; as in Twelfth-Step work, bring a newcomer.

Creating calling cards with C.P.C. committee contact information.

Finding A.A. members with appropriate professional or recovery experience to do C.P.C. work.

Remembering that A.A. is a valuable resource to professionals.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee requests that the font size in the pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Professionals" be increased to be consistent with other Conference-approved pamphlets for professionals.
- The committee reviewed with appreciation the draft service piece on "Guidelines for the Development of Workshops Introducing A.A. in Training Programs for Correctional Personnel" and suggested that the trustees' Committee on Corrections continue to develop the piece. The committee requested that the draft be addressed to training programs for corrections personnel, rather than being limited to training academies; that a

revised draft be circulated to Correctional Facilities, Hospitals and Institutions, and Bridging the Gap area committee chairs for additional sharing; and that the trustees' Committee report back to the 2006 Conference Committee on Corrections.

FINANCE

- The Conference Finance Committee requests that the trustees' Finance Committee develop a "draft finance card" to be used by the groups similar in concept to the "Blue Card" that can explain that in addition to group expenses all levels of service require money to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. This may include a discussion on the spiritual principles of self-support as described on pages 5 and 6 in the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix," and the April 1956 A.A. Grapevine article "More Than Donuts."
- The committee discussed a request to include information on how to obtain a tax ID number in the "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" pamphlet and took no action as the information is currently available in other literature.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee agreed to forward to the Grapevine Corporate Board the request that a collection of A.A. Grapevine stories for young people be produced in the year 2006 or later.
- The committee agreed to forward to the Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that an audio compact disc of La Viña stories on Steps Seven through Twelve be produced in the year 2006 or later.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Grapevine Workbook and suggested that certain editorial changes be made prior to reprinting.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS'

- The committee discussed the 2005 International Convention and heard updates from the 2005 International Convention coordinator and our professional convention consultant, Gregg Talley.
- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested the following:

That groups, districts, and areas develop flyers using the information regarding Regional and Special Forums posted on the web by the General Service Office.

That members consider organizing bus/van trips to Forums.

That more members, particularly sponsors and trusted servants in each region, personally encourage and invite new members to attend Forums with them.

- The committee discussed the concept of restructuring and/or increasing Forums (Regional/Special) and requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums prepare a report on this topic for the 2006 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the revised draft manuscript of the pamphlet "Too Young?" and requested that the Publications Department rewrite the manuscript taking into consideration suggestions from the committee and present the rewritten manuscript to the 2006 Conference Literature Committee following review by the trustees' Literature Committee.
- The committee reviewed the draft manuscript developed to replace the pamphlet "It Happened to Alice!" and requested that the Publications Department rewrite the manuscript taking into consideration suggestions from the committee and present the rewritten manuscript to the 2006 Conference Literature Committee following review by the trustees' Literature Committee.
- The committee considered the request to develop a publication oriented toward and addressing the concerns of A.A. members with long-term sobriety and took no action.
- The committee considered the request to revise the table of contents in *Living Sober* by creating "unity," "service," and "recovery" sections and by including a subtitle under chapter titles and took no action.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee accepted with appreciation the report from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference regarding the use of laptop computers at the General Service Conference.
- The committee discussed regional structure and realignment and requested that the General Service Board furnish a report to the 2006 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee on the feasibility of more balanced composition/structure of regions.
- The committee considered a request that a second Conference Committee on Literature be formed and unanimously agreed to take no action.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee considered the 2004 annual report from the trustees' Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, as requested by the 2004 General Service Conference, and expressed their appreciation for the comprehensiveness of the report.
- The committee reviewed with appreciation the information on centralized redistribution, tracking and evaluation of the "We Know What It's Like" Public Service Announcement (P.S.A.).

- The committee suggested adding additional clarification to the category "Introduction to A.A." on the Membership Survey pamphlet to indicate that "the total responses may add up to more than 100 %."
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee reviewed proposed editorial changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* with appreciation, and selected several items to be brought back with additional background for review by the 2006 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee reviewed the *Final Conference Report* and noted with appreciation the timely distribution of the *2004 Final Conference Report* to the General Service Conference Areas. The committee also considered cost reduction efforts involving the *Final Conference Report* and suggested they be primarily focused on the format and not affect the content.
- The committee considered placement of a central office serving Native North American People in the A.A. directories and took no action.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the results of the 2004 Treatment Facilities Committee Survey and noted that in many areas, inpatient treatment services have decreased and outpatient services have increased; and, many local Treatment Facilities Committees bring A.A. meetings into other institutions such as nursing homes, halfway houses and homeless shelters.
- The committee requested that a summary of the survey results be prepared and that relevant shared experience from the summary be added to the Treatment Facilities Workbook. The revised text will be presented to the 2006 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities. The committee reviewed the contents of the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook and made no additional changes.
- Though A.A. experience with the treatment field has undergone considerable change during the past decade, the committee felt that there is still a strong need for the A.A. message to be brought to treatment professionals and to the alcoholic in treatment settings. The committee discussed the importance of strong Treatment Facilities area chairs.
- In light of A.A.'s recent experience with changes in the treatment field, the committee requested that the 2006 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities reconsider both the scope and name of the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities.
- The committee considered the request that the "Singleness of Purpose" statement currently used in six Cooperation With the Professional Community pamphlets be added to the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities," and took no action.
- Noting that a variety of A.A. literature exists for Treatment Facilities Committees, the committee requested that the Publications Department add an Additional Resources section to the last page of the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities."

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for East Central and Southeast regional trustee and for trustee-at-large/U.S.
- The committee discussed at length the suggestion, "That an appointed committee member not be eligible as a regional trustee or nontrustee director candidate until one year after his or her last service as an appointed committee member," and took no action.
- The committee suggested that the first sentence of the "Composition" section of its Composition, Scope and Procedure, which currently states, "There are not more than nine voting members of this committee and a non-voting secretary," be corrected to read as follows: "There are at least nine voting members of this committee and a non-voting secretary."

NOTE: A 1979 Conference Advisory Action recommended that "The Conference Committee on Trustees always have at least nine members so that there will always be enough to constitute one-half of the committee votes in regional elections."

- The committee reviewed the selection process for adding new members to the 2004 Conference Committee on Trustees and noted that, at that time, only three Panel 54 delegates were selected, creating a committee of eight members. Also, the committee noted that, in order to restore the committee to at least nine members, as outlined in the committee's composition, during the 2005 selection process, six Panel 55 delegates were selected. The committee strongly suggests that four Panel 56 delegates be selected during the selection process for the 2006 Conference Committee on Trustees and that five Panel 57 delegates be selected during the selection process for the 2007 Conference Committee on Trustees, thus restoring the committee to its designated composition.

NOTE: The current "Composition" section of the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Trustees states the following: "The members of the committee will include: Not more than five delegates from the previous year's panel (they continue to serve on this committee for their second year), and not more than five delegates from the current year's panel."

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

CORRECTIONS

- The committee recommended that the draft manuscript of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* that includes revisions suggested by the committee be approved and that the Publications Department maintain editorial responsibilities such as:

Cover and jacket design	Illustrations
Jacket copy	Title page
Preface, if any	Contents page

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

- That the "Singleness of Purpose" statement currently used in six Cooperation With the Professional Community pamphlets, as well as in the Conference Committee on Corrections pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Professionals" (and their workbook) be added to the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" plus the Treatment Facilities Workbook. (**Not approved**)
- "Alcoholism is a disease that ignores sexual preference" be changed to "Alcoholism is a disease that ignores sexual preference (orientation)" on page 10 in the pamphlet "A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic." (**Not approved**)
- That any further "editorial changes" to *The A.A. Service Manual* be included as background material sent to all delegates. (**Not approved**)
- The updated "Alcoholics Anonymous 2004 Membership Survey" pamphlet be approved with the addition of the following new question/category:
Sexual Orientation: Homosexual Heterosexual.
(**Conference voted not to consider**)
- The title of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* be changed to "A.A. member to A.A. member." The stories be focused on A.A. members who found sobriety inside the walls and continued sobriety on the outside. (**Conference voted not to consider**)
- That the title of the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be changed to "Questions and Answers on Recovery and Service Sponsorship." (**Conference voted not to consider**)
- That the A.A. directories include the listing of a central office serving Native North American people. (**Conference voted not to consider**)

